

README — LAMP + WordPress Documentation

Linux • Apache2 • MySQL • PHP • phpMyAdmin • WordPress

About This Documentation Set

This package contains **three documents** covering the full lifecycle of setting up and maintaining a LAMP-based web server running WordPress:

#	File	Purpose
1	Installation Steps	Complete, ordered setup guide from a fresh Linux server to a working LAMP + phpMyAdmin + WordPress stack
2	Error Types & Troubleshooting	Catalog of the 7 most common error categories (including WordPress-specific issues), their causes, and fixes
3	README (this file)	Overview, stack summary, quick command reference, and file locations

What Is LAMP?

LAMP is an open-source web application stack made up of:

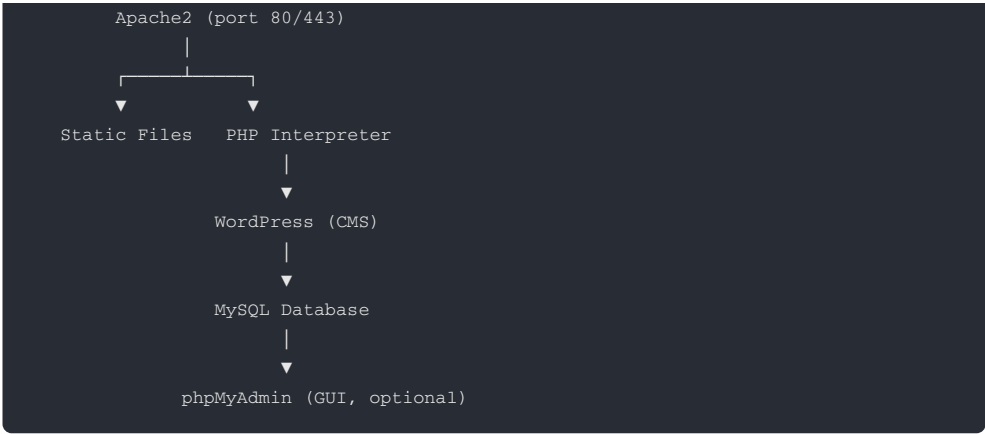
- **L — Linux**: the operating system (this guide targets Ubuntu/Debian)
- **A — Apache2**: the web server that handles HTTP requests
- **M — MySQL**: the relational database that stores application data
- **P — PHP**: the server-side scripting language that powers dynamic pages

phpMyAdmin is added on top as a free, browser-based GUI for managing MySQL databases without needing the command line.

WordPress is a free, open-source Content Management System (CMS) written in PHP that runs on top of this stack. It uses MySQL to store all content (posts, pages, users, settings) and relies on Apache + PHP to render pages dynamically. It is the final application layer in this documentation set.

Stack Summary

Browser Request
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Default File & Directory Locations

Component	Path
Website files	<code>/var/www/html/</code> (or <code>/var/www/your-site/</code>)
Apache main config	<code>/etc/apache2/apache2.conf</code>
Apache site configs	<code>/etc/apache2/sites-available/</code>
Apache error log	<code>/var/log/apache2/error.log</code>
Apache access log	<code>/var/log/apache2/access.log</code>
MySQL config	<code>/etc/mysql/mysql.conf.d/mysqld.cnf</code>
MySQL error log	<code>/var/log/mysql/error.log</code>
PHP config (Apache SAPI)	<code>/etc/php/{version}/apache2/php.ini</code>
phpMyAdmin config	<code>/etc/phpmyadmin/config.inc.php</code>
WordPress root	<code>/var/www/your-site/public_html/</code> (or your site's <code>DocumentRoot</code>)
WordPress config	<code>wp-config.php</code> (in the WordPress root)
WordPress debug log	<code>wp-content/debug.log</code> (after enabling <code>WP_DEBUG_LOG</code>)

Most-Used Commands Cheat Sheet

```
# Service management
sudo systemctl status apache2 mysql
sudo systemctl restart apache2
sudo systemctl restart mysql

# Apache config test before reload
sudo apache2ctl configtest

# Enable/disable a site
```

```

sudo a2ensite mysite.local.conf
sudo a2dissite mysite.local.conf

# Enable an Apache module
sudo a2enmod rewrite
sudo systemctl restart apache2

# MySQL login
mysql -u lampadmin -p

# Check versions
apache2 -v
mysql --version
php -v

# WordPress database backup and restore
mysqldump -u wp_user -p wordpress_db > wp_backup.sql
mysql -u wp_user -p wordpress_db < wp_backup.sql

# Reset WordPress file permissions
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data /var/www/mysite.local/public_html
sudo find /var/www/mysite.local/public_html -type d -exec chmod 755 {} \;
sudo find /var/www/mysite.local/public_html -type f -exec chmod 644 {} \;

```

Recommended Reading Order

1. Start with **Installation Steps** to build the stack from scratch.
2. Keep **Error Types & Troubleshooting** on hand for ongoing maintenance and debugging.
3. Refer back to this **README** for quick lookups of file paths and commands.

Security Reminders

- Always run `mysql_secure_installation` after installing MySQL.
- Delete any `phpinfo()` test files (e.g., `info.php`) after use.
- Keep `display_errors` **Off** on production PHP configs.
- Restrict phpMyAdmin access (e.g., via `.htaccess`, IP allow-listing, or a non-default URL) since it's a common attack target.
- Keep the system updated: `sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y`.
- Keep WordPress core, themes, and plugins updated at all times — they're a frequent attack surface.
- Use a unique, non-`admin` WordPress username and a strong password.
- Set `define( 'DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT', true );` in `wp-config.php` to block dashboard file editing.
- Take regular WordPress database + file backups before any update.

Document Version

Field	Value
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Stack Target	Ubuntu 22.04 / 24.04 LTS
Components	Apache2, MySQL, PHP 8.x, phpMyAdmin, WordPress
Document Set	Installation Steps · Troubleshooting Guide · README